

Chapter 141-2

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Meanwhile, on the other side, Yan Lin was carrying Zhu Mingqi's bag. Zhu Mingqi asked her: "A-Hui¹ still hasn't come?"

"She has something going on at the hospital." Yan Lin bent slightly at the waist, appearing respectful. "It's peak flu season right now, and they can't leave the hospital."

Zhu Mingqi paused, then sighed helplessly: "Why are you still covering for her?"

Yan Lin smiled: "Bomu, I'm really not. A-Hui truly does have something going on."

Zhu Mingqi shot her a sidelong glance: "She came out of my belly—how could I not know her? She definitely doesn't want to come because she thinks I'm trying to set you two up again."

Yan Lin said helplessly: "You've got it wrong there. A-Hui really doesn't mind that kind of thing."

Zhu Mingqi scoffed lightly, "If you ask me, she just hasn't gotten over that... what's her name again?"

Yan Lin reminded her: "Zhao Xuning."

"Right, her." Zhu Mingqi said: "I don't know what's so good about her that she had A-Hui so captivated. If I'd known, I wouldn't have let her study medicine back then. She should have studied finance like you, then she could help share Fenghe's burden."

Yan Lin spoke up for Shen Hui: "They dated in university, and she was A-Hui's first love. Of course she can't let go."

"That's just because she hasn't found someone better." Zhu Mingqi said: "I advised her back then—if you like her, don't break up. But she insisted on breaking up, and after breaking up she won't look for anyone else. I really can't understand you young people."

Yan Lin: "..."

Zhu Mingqi said while looking at the paintings: "It's like these paintings—I'm becoming unable to appreciate them too."

Yan Lin said: "These are all painters that the new generation of young people are particularly fond of."

"Indeed." Zhu Mingqi said: "Trends come and go in waves. Our wave has already passed."

Yan Lin was an honest person who wasn't very good at flattery, so she just listened quietly.

After a while, Yan Lin couldn't suppress her curiosity any longer and asked: "Bomu, do you know that person from earlier?"

Zhu Mingqi happened to stop in front of Chen Mian's painting and first remarked: "This painting is quite distinctive."

"You mean Liang Shi?" Zhu Mingqi then asked.

Yan Lin nodded: "Yes."

"It's the first time I've met her." Zhu Mingqi said: "But she's quite pretty. Doesn't my A-Hui like good-looking people? Especially her eyes—they're quite similar to my eldest's, right? She even has a bit of a couple's look with A-Hui. I thought I could introduce her to my A-Hui. Maybe A-Hui could forget about that what's-her-name Ning."

"Zhao Xuning." Yan Lin reminded her again.

"Mm-hmm, I can never remember that girl's name." Zhu Mingqi said: "But I remember that face. She really is quite pretty—no wonder my A-Hui likes her."

Yan Lin remained silent at the side, secretly sending Shen Hui a message: 【If you don't come soon, your mom is going to marry you off.】

This action was noticed by Zhu Mingqi, who warned in a low voice: "Don't you go tipping off Shen Hui. It's just a thought—I haven't acted on it."

Yan Lin put away her phone and immediately said: "I wasn't..."

"That young lady is already married." Zhu Mingqi said, somewhat disappointed. "My A-Hui doesn't have that fortune."

Yan Lin gave a light cough. "I'm still here, you know."

"Don't think I don't know." Zhu Mingqi gave her a look. "You and A-Hui are just teaming up to deceive us. But feelings—those can't be faked."

Yan Lin: "..."

"If you like someone, even if you cover your mouth, it will show through your eyes." Zhu Mingqi laughed at her: "You and A-Hui each have someone you like. You two are so familiar with each other, yet there's not a shred of romantic feeling between you. It's impossible for it to work out, so of course I have to find someone else for my A-Hui."

Yan Lin: "..."

Yan Lin smiled awkwardly: "You really understand these things."

"Of course." Zhu Mingqi said: "I was someone who dated when I was young too."

"I never would have thought Uncle Shen was so romantic when he was young." Yan Lin teased her: "Your relationship has been this good for decades."

"It wasn't with him." Zhu Mingqi stood in front of Chen Mian's painting without leaving, then finally said: "Let's buy this painting. I'll hang it in the study when I get home."

"Alright." Yan Lin said.

Zhu Mingqi continued from where she left off: "Your Uncle Shen is someone who has been wooden and dull for decades. Like a fool—rigid and boring."

Yan Lin: "..."

"Isn't my eldest exactly like him? Such a fine young lady, and she's already engaged." Zhu Mingqi sighed again when mentioning this. "She doesn't even contact her fiancée. She's an Alpha—why can't she be more proactive? Those two having a meal together every few days only happens because I have someone make the reservations. No wonder the young lady from the Gu family doesn't want to marry her and keeps delaying."

Yan Lin couldn't comment on these matters.

Although Zhu Mingqi was very easygoing, she was still Madam Shen.

Everyone in Haizhou City knew that the Shen and Gu families were the two titans—existences that stood shoulder to shoulder.

The Yan family was beneath these two families.

If it weren't for her close friendship with Shen Hui, she wouldn't have had the opportunity to accompany Zhu Mingqi to an art exhibition like this.

The Shen family members all had good character and would never look down on others. They would even give a helping hand to those they liked.

It was purely based on the other person's character.

But Yan Lin couldn't lack self-awareness.

The marriage alliance between the Shen and Gu families wasn't something she could comment on.

Yan Lin naturally remained silent.

Zhu Mingqi was just venting to her: "Look at that young lady—she looks even younger than A-Hui, yet she's already married. I didn't even dare to ask more, afraid that she might already be holding a baby. As for my two... no, three."

Zhu Mingqi laughed. "Siyan is so quiet at home that I always forget about him. He's about to graduate soon too. Such a wonderful age, and he's handsome too, but he won't properly date anyone. All he does is study all day—exactly like his father. So annoying."

Yan Lin smiled: "Siyan also wants to lighten the burden for Sister Fenghe. After all, A-Hui is willful."

"That's true." Zhu Mingqi said: "A-Hui takes after me—willful. But I'm much more attentive than her. How come she didn't inherit any of that?"

Yan Lin shrugged: "That I don't know."

The two chatted here for a while. Before long, Zhu Mingqi looked into the distance and her expression changed, the smile completely fading from her face.

The person in the distance also cast their gaze over.

Their eyes met.

After a moment, Zhu Mingqi was the first to look away. "Yan Lin, let's go."

Yan Lin was startled: "Bomu, you're not going to keep looking?"

"No." Zhu Mingqi said: "I've run into someone I dislike. If we don't leave, we'll end up arguing soon."

Yan Lin looked around and noticed that not far away, there was a woman in a white long dress glaring fiercely in their direction.

She was a woman about the same age as Zhu Mingqi, but not as well-maintained—she looked somewhat sickly.

"Alright." Yan Lin followed Zhu Mingqi's lead. "Then shall I take you to find A-Hui?"

"That works." Zhu Mingqi walked toward the exit, but suddenly changed her mind as she walked. "Never mind, let's go to that hospital."

"Which one?" Yan Lin was confused.

Zhu Mingqi said: "The hospital where that what's-her-name Ning works. Hasn't she already become an attending physician?² And she skipped grades to get there too."

Yan Lin: "..."

"Don't tell Shen Hui." Zhu Mingqi said: "I'll just register for an appointment, treat it as a health checkup, and take a look while I'm at it."

Yan Lin: "..."

She silently put back the phone she had just picked up, and in her heart, lit a candle for Shen Hui.³

Footnotes:

¹ **A-Hui** (阿茴): A familiar/affectionate way to address someone by adding "A-" (阿) before part of their name. Here it refers to Shen Hui.

² **Attending physician/Resident physician** (住院醫師): In Chinese medical hierarchy, this refers to a doctor who has completed their internship and is now a licensed physician working in a hospital. The text mentions she "skipped grades" (跳級), indicating she advanced faster than the typical timeline.

³ **Lit a candle** (點了根蠟): A Chinese internet slang expression meaning to mourn or express sympathy for someone, similar to saying "RIP" or "thoughts and prayers" in English. It comes from the practice of lighting candles for the deceased. Here, Yan Lin is humorously expressing that Shen Hui is in for trouble since her mother is about to go inspect her ex-girlfriend.